

The Heart Knot

Tuesday, 29 September 2026 · bookkeeping, friction, rulings, table

System and table: the bookkeeping to apply to the live world, automation that cost time, rulings to keep consistent, and what the table said. The combat numbers are in `combat-stats.md`.

Act on this first: the campaign is over, so the checklist is about leaving the world in a clean end state. The one real leftover is **the Thornheart is still on Invictus's sheet (attuned)** — the other three hearts are already gone from theirs.

1 · Bookkeeping checklist (live world)

- ☒ Pudgy raised with the Thornheart (its use recovered at dawn).
- ☒ Midnight removed from Invictus's sheet (you did it at the burial).
- ☒ Honeysuckle's and Pinenut's bodies removed from Gren's inventory.
- ☒ Duskheart, Graveheart, Tideheart gone from Jetten's, Morgash's and Gren's sheets.
- ☐ **The Thornheart is still on Invictus, attuned** (3 attuned: Cloak of Protection, Gauntlets, Thornheart). Remove it.
- ☒ Invictus took the **Scimitar** from the stash (equipped); Morgash took the Ember-Touched Greatsword back.
- ☐ **Standing effects to clear:** Gren shows **Restrained** (from Jetten's R5 Entangle recast), *Mage Armor*, *Protection from Death*, Innate Sorcery and a *Hypnotic Pattern* concentration; Jetten shows Concentrating: Entangle and Bloodied. The post-game Hypnotic Pattern (Pudgy and Invictus rolled Wisdom saves at 01:30) left effects too.
- ☐ Potions of Fire Breath at 0 uses still on Morgash's and Invictus's sheets (from session 8).
- ☐ Rename the actor **Invictus** → **Thomas**? He has his name back; the sheet and the Player Backstories page still say Invictus.
- ☐ Pudgy: an actor exists (he rolled a Wisdom save); if you want him on Gren's side permanently, move him to the party or Gren's companions.
- ☐ Mobs: nothing to do; nobody was killed or tallied — only 39 damage landed on 1,050 HP (Morgash's two Ripostes, 35, were never declared lethal or nonlethal).

- ☐ Bestiary: no new monsters were killed; nothing to add.
- ☐ World-state / plot doc: a closing "how it ended" entry (the story notes carry it).

2 • Automation and friction that cost time

WHAT	TIME LOST	DETAIL
Hypnotic Pattern opening	~3 min	The mobs weren't in the combat tracker yet (shown invisible); Gren's Careful Spell excluded the selected crowd; the cast was refunded and redone twice; the save posted as a Wisdom ability check (12) — you ruled it a failed save by hand.
Sharing Shar's card with Andrew	~2.5 min	Ownership / Show-to-player fumbling before the "Jetten — read this first" page opened for him. Next time: set OBSERVER on the journal for the player before the session.
Entangle recast (R5)	~1.5 min	The template landed in the wrong place ("the purple circle popped up"), fired caltrops damage, and caught Gren (restrained, Str 8) and Jetten (Str 15) as well as the Farmhands (saved 16, 18).
Entangle escape rolls	~1 min	The restrained crowd's escapes posted as Strength ability checks and saves under different mob sheets; a couple of R2 rolls went out under the Farmhands for the entangled crowd.
Find Steed	~1 min	Hunting for the casting time; 2024 has it as an action with no long cast — you ruled instant.
Spellfire Burst — Bolstering Flames	<1 min	Not automated; applied by hand.
Browser lock-up	~15 s	Your browser froze once mid-round 4.
Battle Flow flagged disadvantage on 8 Farmhands attacks	—	6 were rolled straight anyway (2 of those 8 hit). The source of the flag isn't clear from the ledger — worth a look at which effect it read.

3 • Rulings to keep consistent

- **Placing a heart** = a full turn of concentration at the knot; interrupted = start over; one at a time; absorbed at the start of the placer's next turn.
- **Nonlethal**: melee only; same damage; flavour (flat of the blade).

- **Intimidating a mob:** DC 17, rising to 21 and then 25 as the crowd heated up. *Thaumaturgy's* booming voice grants advantage. A success made that mob pause and lose its round.
- **Single-target control on a mob** (Hold Person): affects one person in the crowd — not worth it. Area spells work normally.
- **Find Steed:** instantaneous; mounting takes the action; leaning from the saddle to the knot = Athletics DC 15; taking a hit while leaning = Athletics DC 15 to stay seated.
- **The Thornheart's Raise Dead** was cast as an action, not the spell's hour.
- **Caltrops vs a mob:** a normal 5-ft square even though the mob is bigger.

4 • Table observations

- **Feedback, worth keeping:** Andrew: *"The Dryad should have definitely given us some treasure."* Anthony wanted an interaction with her — a chance to bargain for the town, *"at least have an interaction with the people that save her."* You: *"That's good feedback."*
- **Robert's turn and redemption** carried the first hour: the argument, the prayer, the burial. The group talked him out of it in character, which is exactly the scene the offer was built for.
- **Andrew read Shar's card cold** and well; the "read this first" page worked once he could see it.
- **Session length** 1h51m: ~38 min of story before initiative, a ~40-minute five-round fight, ~15 min of passing and epilogue, then ~30 min of next-campaign talk.
- **Next campaign:** *Echoes of Halruaa* (Forgotten Realms, 2024 rules, levels 1–10+, "a very magical setting"); the pitch is in the Foundry chat. **Tuesdays stay.** Robert is schedule coordinator; the 13th was floated for a one-shot or test characters; you're away next week (Santa Barbara). Class thoughts: Andrew leaning warlock, Robert bard or rogue, Tom flexible, will fit in around the others.
- The Foundry splash screen still shows the stock frost giant — you want to swap it for campaign art.

GM-only. Compiled from the transcript, the chat log and the live sheets by the session scribe.